LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer | Data Platform

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PROFILE

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses across payments, e-commerce and logistics. Experienced in Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Spark, Kafka and AWS, with a strong background in dimensional data modeling, data quality and large-scale batch and streaming pipelines. Focused on reliable, well-tested systems, clear data contracts and reusable platform capabilities. MSc in Computer Science; AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka | 03/2022 - present

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the company data platform, operating approximately 140 Airflow DAGs loading data from PostgreSQL, MySQL, Salesforce and third-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures to more than 420 dbt models with tests and documentation; introduced incremental models and state:modified CI in GitHub Actions, reducing nightly warehouse builds from 5h10 to 1h35.
- Designed JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks between product and data teams, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from approximately 9 per month to 2 per month.
- Designed and built a Kafka event pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming for shipment tracking, handling approximately 30 million events per day with under 2-minute p95 end-to-end latency; added dead-letter and replay tooling.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Optimized Snowflake warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and unused-table usage, reducing monthly spend from approximately $38,000 to $24,000 in 2024.
- Participate in the data platform on-call rotation (one week in six); mentor two mid-level data engineers and run weekly platform office hours.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb | 09/2019 - 02/2022

- Built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files against internal ledgers, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw files from S3 daily; reduced finance team's manual month-end reconciliation from approximately three days to four hours.
- Designed a Redshift dimensional warehouse schema with more than 30 fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams.
- Established Great Expectations data quality checks on critical finance tables.
- Developed an internal Python library for S3 and Glue Data Catalog access, adopted by four teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split | 06/2017 - 08/2019

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL processes feeding an on-premises SQL Server warehouse.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron, making data loads easier to debug and change.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations across more than 40 stores.

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE & COMMUNITY CONTRIBUTIONS

- Contributed two merged pull requests to an Airflow provider for a SaaS CRM API, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests (Python, pytest, 2023).
- Presented "Data contracts without the hype" at a regional data meetup (2024).
- Teach SQL for beginners at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University | 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | May 2024

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data engineering: Airflow, dbt, PySpark, Spark, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Great Expectations
Warehousing & databases: Snowflake, Amazon Redshift, PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server
Cloud & infrastructure: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM, MSK), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)